AIKIA.WALLET / PILOT COSTING

What 3 to 5 cafes cost us to run.

Monthly and yearly running costs for 3 to 5 cafes with 100 to 200 customers each, the cost per cafe, one-time costs, the development still to do, break-even pricing and a roadmap. Prices checked 19 October 2026 at Rs 96 to the US dollar, plus 18% GST on imported software.

Rs 17,311

A MONTH to run 3 cafes with 150 customers each (450 cards), all-in.

Rs 18,841

A MONTH to run 5 cafes with 150 customers each (750 cards). That is Rs 3,768 a cafe.

Rs 2,26,088

A YEAR for 5 cafes, plus Rs 33,000 to Rs 72,000 one-time to start.

The big finding. At this size most of the cost is fixed platform fees, not customers. PassKit also charges about Rs 5 a customer card every month after the first 250. At our earlier Starter price of Rs 4,999 a year (Rs 417 a month) a cafe never covers its own cost. Pilot pricing must be closer to Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,000 a month, or we move to our own Google Wallet engine early.

How to read this. Figures are planning numbers, not quotes. S = price found in a published source (re-check on the vendor page before paying). E = our estimate. Founder time is not costed. Development is shown separately because most of the product is already built.

1 / MONTHLY RUNNING COSTS

The fixed bill: the same for 1 cafe or 5

These are the services that keep the product online for every cafe. They don't grow with the number of cafes until well past 5.

Service and why	Price basis	Src	Rs a month
PassKit, platform fee (1 user) Issues and updates the Google (and later Apple) wallet cards. Includes the first 250 cards.	US$39.50 a month	S	Rs 3,792
Vercel Pro (1 seat) Hosts the app: join page, staff scanner, owner dashboard, guest pages. The free Hobby plan is for non-commercial use only.	US$20 a seat a month, usage credit included	S	Rs 1,920
Supabase Pro Database, ledger, logins and backups. The free plan pauses after 7 days without activity, which is not safe for paying cafes.	US$25 a month, US$10 compute credit included	S	Rs 2,400
Apple Developer Program Needed to make cards permanent on PassKit (the certificate) and for iPhone cards.	US$99 a year, shown per month	S	Rs 792
Weather data, commercial licence (Open-Meteo Standard) Weather-mood messages. The free Open-Meteo API is for non-commercial use.	US$29 a month in Open-Meteo's own announcement; confirm on its pricing page	S	Rs 2,784
Chartered accountant (GST and books) GST registration, monthly returns, invoices to cafes.	monthly retainer	E	Rs 2,500
GST at 18% on the imported services (US$121.75 a month)			Rs 2,104
Fixed total a month			**Rs 16,292**

Free at this size

Service	Why it's enough	Cost
Login-link email (Resend free tier)	3,000 emails a month, 100 a day. Enough for 5 cafes' owners and staff.	Rs 0 (US$20 a month only past the free limits)
Google Wallet API	Used later by our own engine. No per-card fee found.	Rs 0
Code hosting (GitHub), error alerts (free tiers)	Source code, automatic checks, crash alerts.	Rs 0 at this size
Domain	A sub-domain of aikia.world (for example wallet.aikia.world). aikia.world is already paid for by the agency.	Rs 0 extra
Staff devices	Staff use their own phone or the cafe's tablet to scan.	Rs 0

Customer cards. PassKit includes 250 stored cards. After that each card costs US$0.045 a month (cards 251 to 2,500), about Rs 5 with GST, every month the card exists, used or not. Cards of customers who leave should be deleted so they stop costing.

2 / 3 TO 5 CAFES

Monthly and yearly, by number of cafes and customers

On PassKit (today's set-up)

Cafes x customers	Cards	Fixed	Cards fee	A month	A year	Per cafe a month	Per customer a month
3 cafes x 100	300	Rs 16,292	Rs 255	**Rs 16,547**	Rs 1,98,561	Rs 5,516	Rs 55
3 cafes x 150	450	Rs 16,292	Rs 1,020	**Rs 17,311**	Rs 2,07,736	Rs 5,770	Rs 38
3 cafes x 200	600	Rs 16,292	Rs 1,784	**Rs 18,076**	Rs 2,16,912	Rs 6,025	Rs 30
5 cafes x 100	500	Rs 16,292	Rs 1,274	**Rs 17,566**	Rs 2,10,795	Rs 3,513	Rs 35
5 cafes x 150	750	Rs 16,292	Rs 2,549	**Rs 18,841**	Rs 2,26,088	Rs 3,768	Rs 25
5 cafes x 200	1000	Rs 16,292	Rs 3,823	**Rs 20,115**	Rs 2,41,380	Rs 4,023	Rs 20

On our own Google Wallet engine (after Google approves publishing)

No PassKit fee and no per-card fee. The Apple Developer fee is kept for iPhone cards later.

Cafes x customers	Cards	Fixed	Cards fee	A month	A year	Per cafe a month	Per customer a month
3 cafes x 100	300	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 3,939	Rs 39
3 cafes x 150	450	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 3,939	Rs 26
3 cafes x 200	600	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 3,939	Rs 20
5 cafes x 100	500	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 2,363	Rs 24
5 cafes x 150	750	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 2,363	Rs 16
5 cafes x 200	1000	Rs 11,817	Rs 0	**Rs 11,817**	Rs 1,41,807	Rs 2,363	Rs 12

What the switch saves. For 5 cafes with 150 customers each, our own engine costs Rs 11,817 a month instead of Rs 18,841: about Rs 84,280 a year less. The code for it is already built and was tested on 6 October; it is waiting for Google's publishing approval.

3 / ONE CAFE

The cost of one cafe, to set its price

A cafe's true cost is its share of the fixed bill plus its customers' cards. The share falls as more cafes join.

Number of cafes sharing the fixed bill	Fixed share a month	Its 150 cards (past the free 250)	Cost of one cafe a month	A year
1 cafe	Rs 16,292	Rs 0	**Rs 16,292**	Rs 1,95,502
3 cafes	Rs 5,431	Rs 765	**Rs 6,195**	Rs 74,343
5 cafes	Rs 3,258	Rs 765	**Rs 4,023**	Rs 48,276
10 cafes	Rs 1,629	Rs 765	**Rs 2,394**	Rs 28,726
25 cafes	Rs 652	Rs 765	**Rs 1,416**	Rs 16,996

What we spend on each cafe besides software

Item	When	Cost
QR standee and counter poster	Once, at onboarding	Rs 300 to 500
Onboarding visit: set up venue, tiers, staff, train the counter (about 2 hours)	Once	Founder time
Payment fee when the cafe pays us by card (about 2% plus GST); UPI is free	Each payment	about 2.36%
Support calls and changes to offers	Monthly	Founder time

Data and the ledger. 5 cafes with 200 customers each is about 1,000 members. A year of visits is still only tens of thousands of ledger lines, a few MB. Supabase Pro covers this many times over, with daily backups. Data use is not a cost driver until thousands of cafes.

4 / PRICING

How many cafes cover the bill

Cafes needed before the monthly bill is covered, at different monthly prices (150 customers a cafe, after a 2.36% card-payment fee).

Price per cafe	On PassKit	On our own Google engine
Rs 417 a month (Rs 4,999 a year)	never	30 cafes
Rs 999 a month	78 cafes	13 cafes
Rs 1,499 a month	24 cafes	9 cafes
Rs 1,999 a month	14 cafes	7 cafes
Rs 2,999 a month	8 cafes	5 cafes

What this means for the pilot

- **The pilot runs at a loss, and that is normal.** With 5 cafes at Rs 1,499 a month we collect Rs 7,495 and spend about Rs 18,841: a gap of about Rs 11,346 a month. That gap is the price of proof.
- **Charge a one-time setup fee.** Rs 2,999 to Rs 4,999 per cafe covers the standee, the onboarding visit and part of the legal set-up.
- **Suggested pilot offer:** setup Rs 2,999, then Rs 1,499 a month (or Rs 14,999 a year paid upfront), with credit and gifts as a Growth add-on once the lawyer approves.
- **Move to our own Google engine as soon as Google approves.** It removes the biggest fixed fee and the per-card fee, so about 8 to 10 cafes at Rs 1,499 cover the bill.

> **Re-price the old plans.** The earlier Rs 4,999-a-year Starter plan does not cover cost at any number of cafes on PassKit. Keep it only for the own-engine set-up and only at 25+ cafes.

5 / ONE-TIME COSTS AND DEVELOPMENT

What to pay once, and the build that is left

One-time item	When	Src	Cost
Lawyer: cafe agreement, privacy notice (DPDP Act), programme terms	Before the first paying cafe	E	Rs 25,000 to Rs 60,000
CA: GST registration and set-up	Before invoicing cafes	E	Rs 2,000 to Rs 5,000
Trademark filing for aikia.wallet (1 class, e-filing, individual or small business)	Government fee; agent fees extra if used	S	Rs 4,500
QR standee and counter poster, per cafe x 5	Rs 300 to 500 per cafe	E	Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,500
Lawyer: written opinion on venue-only prepaid credit	Only before cafes take real money as credit	E	Rs 50,000 to Rs 1,00,000
Before the first paying cafe (first four lines)			**Rs 33,000 to Rs 72,000**
Including the credit legal opinion			**Rs 83,000 to Rs 1,72,000**

Development still to do

The product for 3 to 5 cafes is already built and live: cards, join page, staff scanner, scan-and-charge, tiers, offers, weather messages, credit and gifts. What is left:

Work	When	Effort
Own email sender and custom domain for the app	Before pilot	1 days
Monitoring, uptime alerts, backup restore test	Before pilot	2 days
Security review and fixes before real customers	Before pilot	5 days
Testing on real Android phones at a cafe counter	Before pilot	3 days
Apple Wallet switch-on and test (after the certificate)	Before pilot	2 days
Sales demo (browser demo) updated with credit and gifts	Later	3 days
Online top-up through the cafe's own Razorpay / UPI account	Later	15 days
Own Google Wallet engine switch-over and card migration	Later	3 days

Who builds it	Before pilot (13 days)	Everything (34 days)
Us, with Claude (what we did so far)	Rs 0 extra cash	Rs 0 extra cash
Partner company at about Rs 70,000 a person-month (assumption; ask them to quote)	Rs 43,333	Rs 1,13,333

6 / BUDGET

Monthly and yearly budget to keep aside

Budget line	3 cafes, 150 each	5 cafes, 150 each	5 cafes, 200 each
Running cost a month (PassKit)	Rs 17,311	Rs 18,841	Rs 20,115
Running cost a year (PassKit)	Rs 2,07,736	Rs 2,26,088	Rs 2,41,380
One-time start (without credit opinion), upper end	Rs 72,000	Rs 72,000	Rs 72,000
Contingency 15% on the year	Rs 31,160	Rs 33,913	Rs 36,207
Year one total to keep aside	**Rs 3,10,897**	**Rs 3,32,001**	**Rs 3,49,588**
Same, if we move to our own Google engine from month 3	Rs 2,47,715	Rs 2,51,232	Rs 2,54,163

Cheapest safe start. While cafes are on free trial, the bill can stay near Rs 5,409 a month: PassKit plus Apple only, on the free Vercel and Supabase plans. Switch Vercel and Supabase to paid the day the first cafe pays, because the free plans don't allow commercial use or may pause.

7 / ROADMAP

From demo to 5 paying cafes

When	Goal	What we do	Monthly cost
Weeks 0 to 2	Demos and first yes	Show the live demo in 10 to 15 Vadodara cafes. Sign 3 pilot cafes. Lawyer drafts the cafe agreement and privacy notice. CA registers GST.	about Rs 5,409
Weeks 2 to 4	Cards that last	Enrol in Apple Developer and upload the certificate to PassKit, so cards stop expiring after 48 hours. Finish the Google business profile and ask Google for publishing access. Own email sender.	about Rs 5,409
Weeks 4 to 8	3 cafes live	Switch Vercel and Supabase to paid. Onboard 3 cafes: tiers, staff, standee, 2-hour training. Weekly check-in, fix what the counter staff report.	Rs 17,311
Months 3 to 4	5 cafes, own engine	Add 2 more cafes. When Google approves, switch to our own Google engine and re-issue cards. Credit only after the lawyer's written opinion.	Rs 11,817 to Rs 18,841
Months 5 to 6	Price and proof	Measure repeat visits per cafe, fix the price, write 2 case studies, then sell to 10 to 25 cafes.	Rs 11,817 and up

Risks that change the cost

- **PassKit draft mode.** Until the Apple certificate is uploaded, cards are deleted after about 48 hours. Do not onboard real customers before this.
- **Nearby (geofence) messages.** On PassKit, location alerts work on Apple Wallet only. On Android, weather offers still reach guests as card messages, but not as "you are near the cafe" alerts.
- **Dollar rate.** Most costs are in US dollars. Every Rs 5 move in the rate changes the fixed bill by about Rs 718 a month.
- **Cards that are never deleted.** PassKit bills every stored card. Clean up members who leave, every month.

Sources (checked 19 Oct 2026)

- PassKit pricing model: help.passkit.com/en/articles/3133669-the-passkit-pricing-model (platform fee, card tiers, Apple certificate, location alerts Apple only)
- Vercel Pro US$20 a seat and Hobby non-commercial: makerkit.dev/blog/saas/vercel-cost; community.vercel.com (commercial use needs Pro)
- Supabase Pro US$25 and free-plan pausing: jetadmin.io/blog/supabase-pricing-2026-guide-to-plans-limits-and-real-world-costs
- Open-Meteo commercial plans: openmeteo.substack.com/p/api-subscriptions-for-commercial; open-meteo.com/en/pricing
- Resend free tier and Pro: resend.com/docs/knowledge-base/what-is-resend-pricing
- Rupee rate about 96.5 per US$: pluang.com currency converter, mid-October 2026
- Card payment fee about 2% plus GST, UPI free: AIKIA.WALLET Budget Plan (October 2026)